YOUR PARENTING PROFILE



The Croquembouche

P C T E

Grand plans, big feelings, bigger adventures.

Your four letters

Your code is built from four research-backed parenting dimensions. Neither pole of any dimension is the better one.



P — HOW YOU ORGANIZE THE DAY
Planner

C — WHO SETS THE DIRECTION
Captain

T — WHEN THE FEELINGS GET BIG
Talker

E — COMFORT ZONE OR STRETCH ZONE
Explorer

For fun & reflection — not a clinical assessment or diagnostic tool.

AN EVERYDAY STORY

The Sunday That Wasn't a Masterpiece

At 7:12 on Sunday morning, the table is already holding fruit slices, water bottles, museum tickets, and a plan for making today special. Then the rain comes. Your child refuses to get dressed and climbs into an old cardboard box instead. Looking at everything you prepared, a small verdict appears: I can't even make one family day go right.

Being The Croquembouche can feel like stacking too many delicate pieces into one beautiful tower. You carry the schedule, the snacks, the excitement, and everybody's feelings, then blame yourself when one piece falls.



This morning, you don't rescue the plan. You keep your coffee warm, cancel one optional stop, and take ten minutes that do not need to be useful or shareable.

When you return, your child holds out the scissors. “Help me make a window?” There is no museum and no perfect photo. Just a crooked cardboard window, a small laugh, and your shoulders finally softening. Maybe your child did not need a bigger day. Maybe both of you just needed you to come back to yourself first.



WHAT OFTEN HAPPENS

You often become the family project manager: schedules, snacks, big experiences, and everyone's feelings all at once. When the plan falls apart, it can feel like failure when you were simply carrying too much.

RELEASE THE GUILT

Your child does not need every day to be a masterpiece. A failed plan is not proof that you are a failed parent; it was one day that became too full.



YOUR SUPERPOWERS

1. You turn ordinary weekends into events
2. You can talk your kid through anything
3. Fearless cheerleader: "Try it, I've got you"

WATCH-OUT, WITH LOVE

Sometimes you over-engineer the fun. Plot twist: the cardboard box always wins. 📦

YOUR POP-CULTURE COUSIN

Ambitious Pinterest-parent energy



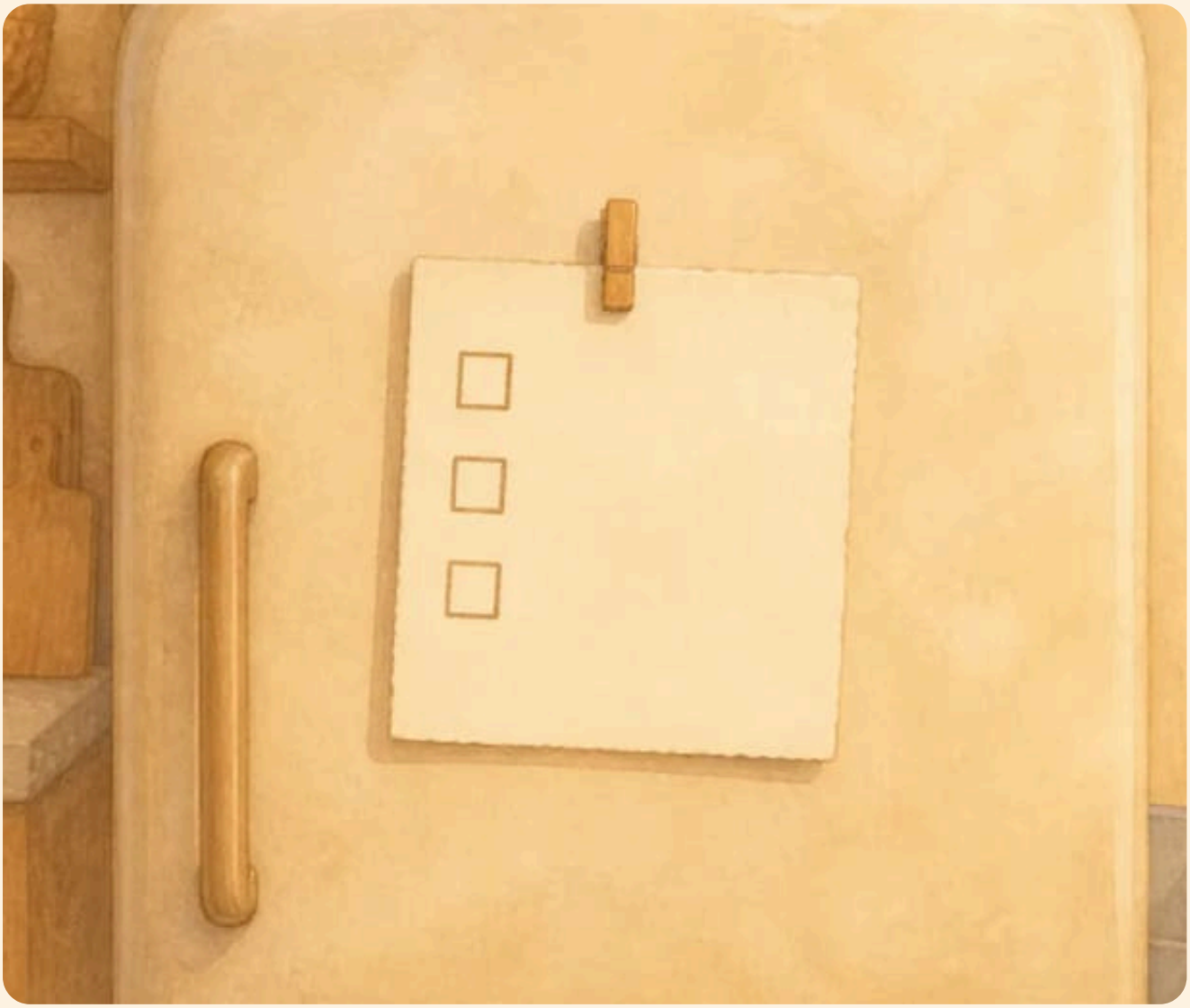
WHAT TO REMEMBER

Try this week

- [ ] Cancel one optional plan
- [ ] Take 10 minutes for something only you enjoy
- [ ] If you became too controlling, say: “I got tense earlier. Let's try again together.”

EXTRAS FOR YOUR STYLE

- [ ] Let one plan change without correcting it.
- [ ] Give your child one genuine choice today — one where you'd accept either answer.
- [ ] After you name the feeling, stay quiet for ten seconds before anything else.
- [ ] Stop at the first try if they say that's enough.



FOR YOU FIRST

5 ways to come back to yourself

Chosen from your style: what you spend yourself on is what needs releasing. Not one of these is for your child.

There's an order most of us have backwards: everyone else gets looked after first, and you get whatever is left. But what's left at nine at night isn't you — it's the part of you that never got to rest.

The next five pages don't ask you to be a better parent. Nothing here is counted, nothing is reported, and not one of them is for your child. They're all for you, and they aren't a reward you have to earn first.

What's on them isn't random either. Every parenting style spends itself differently: some parents run out from anticipating, some from deciding, some from holding everybody's feelings. So whatever drains you most is also what most needs releasing.



WHAT DRAINS YOU MOST

P — HOW YOU ORGANIZE THE DAY

Anticipating. Your head keeps running even when your body sits down.

C — WHO SETS THE DIRECTION

Steering. You're the one who always has to know the next move.

T — WHEN THE FEELINGS GET BIG

Absorbing feelings. Your ears have been on shift since morning.

E — COMFORT ZONE OR STRETCH ZONE

Being the energy. Every bit of the fun sets off from you first.

FOR YOU FIRST

Keep one enjoyable moment that does not need to be useful, educational, or shareable. Joy without an output still counts.

HOW TO USE THESE

Take just one. If only one of these gets used this week, that worked. The rest stay here; they aren't going anywhere.

No time this week? You are still enough.



TIME 5 MIN

One drink while it's still hot

Almost every parent drinks their coffee cold. Not from lack of time, but because there is always one more thing that comes first.

Sit down. Finish the whole thing at its actual temperature, doing nothing else at the same time.



TIME 5 MIN

Empty your head onto paper

Your head is holding every open loop because it doesn't trust anything else to remember. Paper turns out to be enough.

Write every unfinished thing on one sheet. No order, no priorities, no tidying.



TIME 10 MIN

Hand over the wheel for ten minutes

What tires you isn't the work, it's being the one who decides. Ten minutes of not being in charge is real rest.

Let someone else decide something real and small, and do not improve their decision afterwards.



TIME 10 MIN

Ten minutes with no voices

Your ears have been on shift since morning — hearing, naming, soothing. Ten wordless minutes isn't loneliness, it's a break.

No podcast, no music with words, no conversation. Ten minutes.



TIME 5 MIN

The boring route, on purpose

Repetition isn't a failure of imagination. It's the rest your imagination is asking for.

Take the familiar way. Order the usual. Just this once, don't look for the new thing.

5 activities with your child (0–5)

One for each age range, so you can take the one that fits your child right now. Everything is already in your house.



THEN, FOR YOUR CHILD

Under all the big experiences, the clearest message your child can receive is simple: you stay present even when the event does not go to plan.



0–12 MONTHS · 10 MIN

Just out of reach

Babies learn movement from effort, not from being handed things. That small gap is where the trying happens.

1. Lay your baby on a firm, flat surface.
2. Put one interesting object a hand's width past their fingers.
3. Say nothing and wait, even when it takes a while. Don't slide it closer.

You'll need: One object with texture or a soft sound.

Safety first: Firm surface, never a bed or a sofa edge. The object must be too big to pass through a toilet-paper tube.

Grounded in: Montessori — freedom of movement



1–2 YEARS · 10 MIN

In, out, again

Repetition isn't boredom to a toddler — it's how they confirm the world is predictable.

1. Cut one hand-sized hole in a box lid, or use a wide-mouth jar.
2. Show it once, slowly, then hand it over.
3. Let them repeat it far past the point where you're bored.

You'll need: A box or wide jar, plus large objects: jar lids, blocks, wooden rings.

Safety first: Every object larger than a toilet-paper tube, and no cut edges on the hole.

Grounded in: Montessori — order



2–3 YEARS · 10 MIN

Pour from a small jug

The classic Montessori presentation: show once, then hand over control completely.

1. Half-fill a small jug and set two cups on a tray.
2. Pour once, slowly, without narrating.
3. Put the cloth where they can reach it and say nothing about spills.

You'll need: A small unbreakable jug and two unbreakable cups, a tray, a cloth.

Safety first: Room-temperature water only. Use light, unbreakable vessels and keep an adult within arm's reach.

Grounded in: Montessori — practical life



3–4 YEARS · 20 MIN

Special play time

This is the weekly session used in filial therapy, run by the parent at home. If you try only one activity in this booklet, make it this one.

1. 20 minutes, one child, a consistent time and place, phone in another room.
2. They choose everything. You follow, and join in only when invited — no teaching, no questions, no suggestions.
3. Describe what you see ("You're giving the baby a bottle"), reflect what they feel ("That surprised you"), and praise the effort, never the result ("You kept trying until you got it").
4. Give a five-minute and a one-minute warning before you stop.

You'll need: Simple non-mechanical things: paper and crayons, a doll, animals, blocks, cars.

Safety first: Use intact, age-appropriate toys with no loose batteries or small parts. An adult stays in the room.

Grounded in: Filial therapy — special play time



4–5 YEARS · 15 MIN

A treasure map of our house

Drawing a map and then following it is symbolic thinking with legs.

1. They draw a map of a room, however inaccurate.
2. Hide a small soft toy or block together and mark it.
3. Follow their map, not your knowledge of the house.

You'll need: Paper, crayons, one small soft toy or block to hide.

Safety first: Agree which rooms are in play. If a child under three lives in the home, choose an object too large for a toilet-paper tube.

Grounded in: Montessori — order



No play today? You are still enough.

Keep it, print it, or forget it

This booklet has no targets and counts nothing. Take the one thing that helps and leave the rest.



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